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LETTERS TO MY SON

On Health

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

The body is the one instrument you cannot replace. These letters are on guarding it, so it can carry the life you mean to build.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

We suffer more in imagination than in reality.

Half your dread is for things that never arrive. Meet the real trouble; ignore the rehearsed one.

Carry only the weight that is actually on your back.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Drunkenness is nothing but a state of self-induced madness.

Every escape you pour or scroll or chase leaves you further from the thing you fled.

Face the evening sober; that is where strength is built.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The body is more necessary than important.

You cannot do anything without it, yet a man who lives for it lives small.

Keep the body strong, but never let it become your master.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A plain supper and an early night will do more for you than any physician.

Most of what ruins a man's health, he pours or scrolls into himself by choice.

Guard your sleep and your plate; the rest follows.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Live with men as if a higher thing watched; speak as if men listened.

The man who needs no audience to behave well has healed something in himself.

Be whole when no one is checking.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A plain supper and an early night outdo any physician.

Most of what ruins a man's health, he pours or scrolls into himself by choice.

Guard your sleep and your plate; the rest follows.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Drunkenness is a madness a man chooses and calls rest.

Every escape you pour leaves you further from the thing
you fled.

Meet the evening sober; strength is built there.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Move the body when the mind ties itself in knots.

An hour on your feet untangles what a day at the desk
could not.

When thinking fails, walk.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Your body is the one instrument you cannot replace.

Every plate is a small letter to the man you will become.

Feed him well; he has work to do.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Eat plainly, drink rarely, and let the body do its quiet work.

Most of what men pay doctors to fix, they first paid pleasure to cause.

Spare the body the harm and it asks little else.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The early hour belongs to the man who claims it.

While the world sleeps, the disciplined build the lead
they keep all day.

Rise before you must; own the quiet edge.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Rest is not the reward for the work; it is part of it.

The bow always bent loses the spring that made it useful.

Unstring yourself on purpose, or snap by accident.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The soul cramped in an abused body cannot do its finest work.

Neglect the vessel and you starve the thing it carries.

Keep the body fit so the mind runs free.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Temperance at the table spares you a hundred later sorrows.

Most ailments a man brings on himself, one small excess at a time.

Stop one bite early; thank yourself for years.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Health is the foundation of everything else.

A weak body makes for a weak mind.

Start today, not tomorrow.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Your body is the one machine you cannot replace.

A weak body makes for a weak mind.

This is your greatest possession.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father